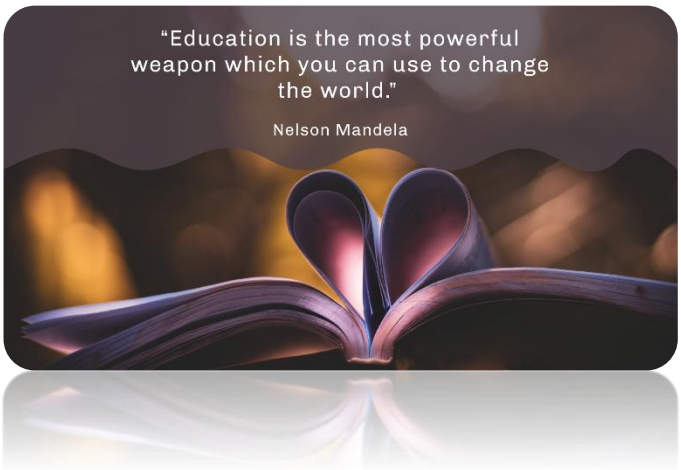
ILAKKU

ANNUAL REPORT 2024-25

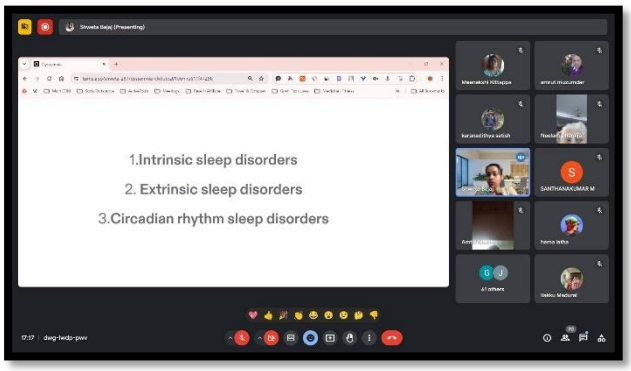


Mentor teachers of the year

We have carefully identified and assembled a group of students who have demonstrated a genuine passion for teaching and leadership. From this group, we have formed a dedicated team of Mentor Teachers who will take on the responsibility of leading our Life Skills classes throughout the year. These classes go beyond academics, focusing on equipping our students with essential practical skills, values, and knowledge that can be applied in their everyday lives—whether it be communication, problem-solving, decision-making, or emotional well-being.The Mentor Teachers, with their enthusiasm and commitment, are not only stepping into the role of guides but also role models for their peers. By facilitating discussions, activities, and interactive sessions, they will help create a learning environment that is both engaging and empowering. We believe this initiative will nurture confidence and responsibility in our Mentor Teachers while ensuring that all students gain meaningful life skills that will support their personal growth and future endeavors.

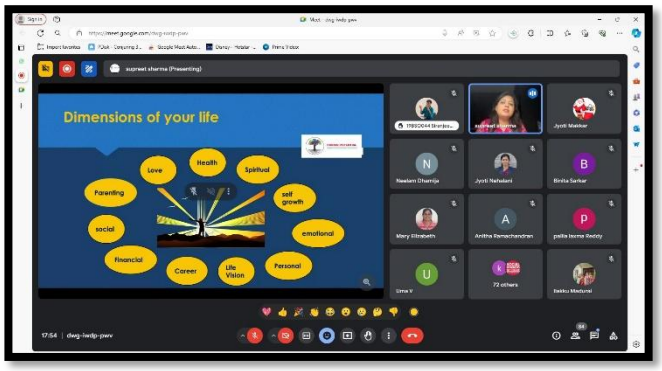
Online Webinars

Online Webinar on "What is Dyssomnia, Types, Symptoms, and Treatment?"



On April 15, 2024, a webinar titled "What is Dyssomnia, Types, Symptoms, and Treatment?" was conducted by Ms. Shweta Bajaj, a Certified Counsellor and health and nutrition life coach. She explained that Dyssomnia refers to a group of sleep disorders affecting the quality and quantity of sleep, including insomnia, hypersomnolence, and excessive daytime sleepiness. Dyssomnia can be caused by medical, mental health, or lifestyle factors and is classified into three categories:1.Intrinsic disorders (e.g., insomnia, narcolepsy, sleep apnoea, restless legs syndrome).2.Extrinsic disorders (e.g., poor sleep hygiene, nocturnal eating syndrome).3.Circadian rhythm disorders (disruptions to the body's sleep-wake cycle). Treatment may include medication, cognitive behavioural therapy**,** lifestyle changes, and maintaining a healthy sleep routine.A total of 17 students attended the session, gaining valuable insights into sleep disorders and treatment methods. Those who participated found it highly informative and useful.

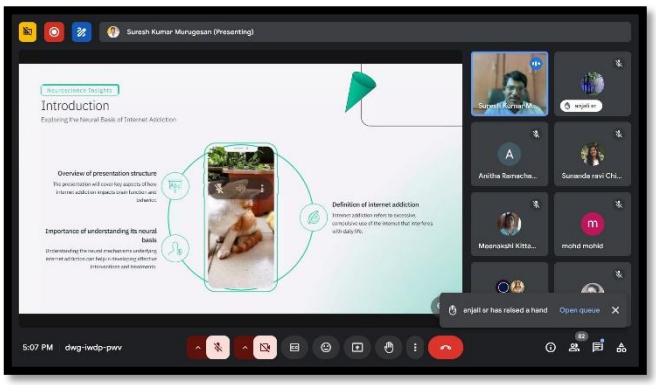
Online Webinar on “Setting Goals to Reduce Stress”



On 17th May 2024, an Online webinar on "Setting Goals to Reduce Stress" was led by Ms. Supreet Kaur, a certified life skills trainer and the founder of Hidden Potential. She discussed the following during her webinar session: what we perceive as 'stress' is an interplay of events that occur in our lives, our thoughts, and the resulting emotional reactions to those events. The way we perceive our stressors and our emotional responses to those perceptions are what trigger the body's stress response, resulting in the experience of stress. Stress management focuses on understanding our thoughts about stress and aims to change our emotional and stress responses. It also involves reducing the stressors we encounter in our daily lives. Stress is an inevitable part of life, ranging from minor challenges to major crises. While we may not always have control over our circumstances, we can control how we react to them. When stress becomes overwhelming or chronic, it can have a significant impact on our overall well-being. Therefore, it is crucial to have effective stress-relief techniques that can help calm both the mind and body. Techniques such as deep breathing and meditation are fast-acting tools that can be practiced anywhere, at any time. Whether preparing for a job interview or feeling overwhelmed by a child's behavior at the playground, having these stress reduction tools can provide immediate relief. Striving towards your goals with a practical mindset, even if it means a longer journey, can be the key to staying committed and ultimately achieving success. Take small steps towards your goals each week or month, and make sure to celebrate each little victory along the way - you've earned it!

Twenty-four students from Madurai and Ramnad Academy attended the webinar today. This Sunday, we will be hosting a goal-setting workshop, which is intended to provide our students with deeper insights into goal-setting as a follow-up to the webinar.

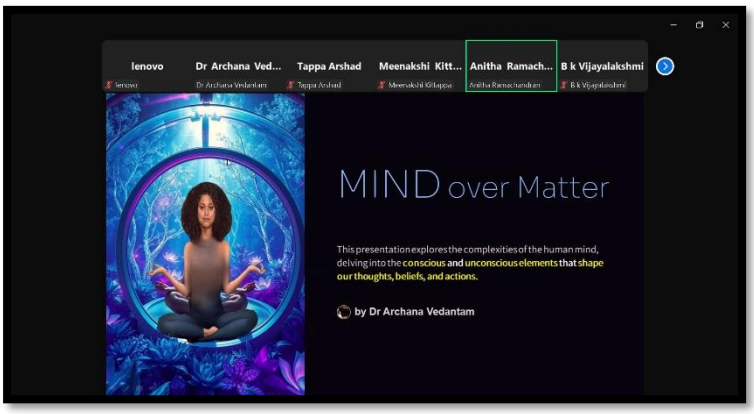
Online Webinar on "The Neuroscience of Internet Addiction"



We attended an online webinar focused on "The Neuroscience of Internet Addiction" led by Dr. Suresh Kumar Murugesan. Throughout the session, Dr. Murugesan delved into various captivating topics, such as exploring the neural basis of internet addiction, discussing the characteristics and symptoms of internet addiction, and understanding the global impact by examining prevalence and demographics. Moreover, he shed light on the key brain regions associated with internet addiction, the influence of dopamine on internet addiction, and how the brain adapts to internet addiction through neuroplasticity and habit formation. Dr. Murugesan also discussed the impact on brain function, explored the interplay between emotions and online behavior, and

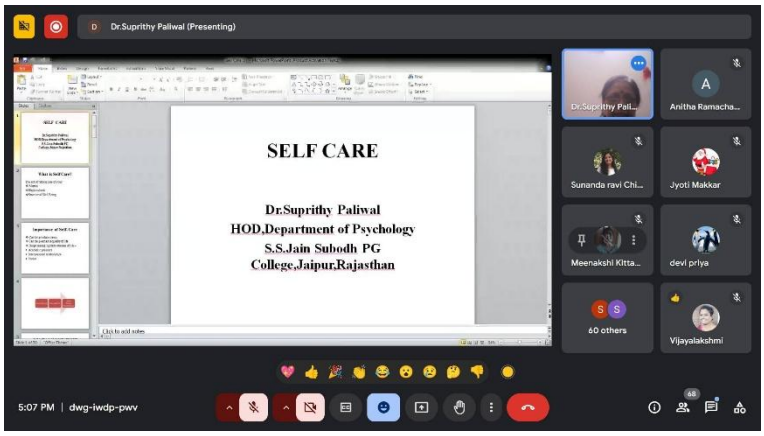
delved into the social and psychological impacts of internet addiction. Furthermore, he provided insights into diagnostic tools, treatment approaches, prevention strategies, and future research directions. A total of fourteen students actively participated in this informative webinar.

Online Webinar on "Mind Over Matter"



We attended an enlightening online webinar titled "Mind over Matter," facilitated by Dr. Archana Vedantam, Advocate and Counsellor. The session explored the profound influence of the mind on our lives, covering topics such as identity, the conscious and subconscious mind, reprogramming thought patterns, and the impact of unconscious influences**.** Dr. Vedantam also highlighted the role of neural pathways and the Reticular Activating System **(RAS)**, emphasized the importance of thoughts and beliefs, and introduced practical tools like mindfulness practices to enhance self-awareness. The webinar concluded with strategies for changing negative thought patterns, leaving participants equipped with valuable insights to cultivate a positive and resilient mindset.

Online Webinar on "Self-Care"



An online webinar on "Self Care" was conducted by Dr. Suprithy Paliwal, Associate Professor and Head of the Department of Psychology at S.S. Jain Subodh PG College, Jaipur. The webinar delved into various aspects of self-care, including its definition, significance, compassion fatigue, signs of potential burnout, and the categorization of self-care into eight types: Physical, Mental, Emotional, Spiritual, Intellectual, Environmental, Social, and Financial. Despite encountering challenges such as heavy rain and internet disruptions, the webinar was attended by fourteen dedicated students.

Online Webinar on “Ashtanga Yoga”

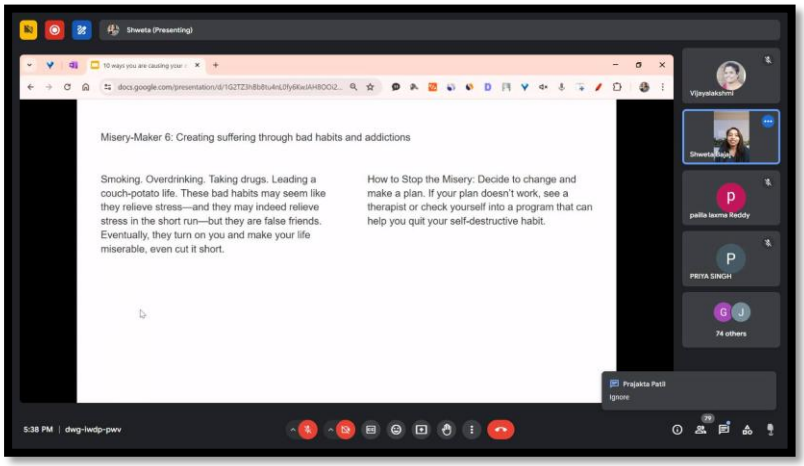
In an online webinar on "Ashtanga Yoga," Ms. Jaya, a Counseling Psychologist and founder of Pratyahaara Life School and Counseling, shared valuable insights. Throughout the session, she delved into the essence of yoga, its historical roots, and explored Ashtanga yoga, distinguishing between its two types - Bahiranga yoga and Antharanga yoga. She also discussed the five layers of the body, Yama, Niyama, Asanas, Pranayama, Life Span, Pratyahara, Dharana, Dhyana, ways to engage in meditation, and the concept of Samadhi. For today’s takeaway: "Many things will become a few things, A few things will become one thing, One thing will become nothing, Then we will know everything. All of this will happen through meditation. “Nineteen students have participated in the webinar.

Online Webinar on "Trends in Family Counseling."

An online webinar, led by the esteemed Dr. Suresh Kumar Murugesan, delved deep into the intricate realm of "Trends in Family Counseling." Dr. Murugesan eloquently outlined the fundamental principles of family Counseling, emphasizing the pivotal role of this therapeutic discipline in addressing the myriad challenges and complexities of family life. During the insightful session, Dr. Murugesan meticulously expounded upon the nuances of family Counseling, elucidating its focus on enhancing communication and harmonizing familial dynamics to mitigate dysfunction. He underscored the distinction between family Counseling and family therapy, shedding light on the concise, solution-driven nature of the former.

The comprehensive discussion encompassed the goals, common issues, stages, techniques, and diverse approaches in family Counseling. Dr. Murugesan also delineated the far-reaching benefits, successful outcomes, and evolving landscape of this crucial field. Concluding the session, he imparted the compelling slogan "Empowering families together," encapsulating the collaborative spirit of this noble endeavour. Twenty-seven students have participated in the webinar.

Online Webinar on ““Scientific Ways to Recover from Traumatic Experiences”



We attended an online webinar on “Scientific Ways to Recover from Traumatic Experiences” led by psychologist Ms. Shweta. She explained that trauma arises from negative events like loss, abuse, accidents, or natural disasters, and can lead to PTSD. The emotional journey of trauma often mirrors the five stages of grief: denial, anger, bargaining, depression, and acceptance. Recovery timelines differ—20% recover within three months, 27% within six months, 50% within two years, and 77% within a decade.

Ms. Shweta also shared ten healing strategies: accepting support, seeking professional help, connecting with others, physical activity, acknowledging emotions, practicing self-care, avoiding substances, taking breaks, mindfulness, and creative pursuits. The session was highly insightful and benefited the 23 participants.

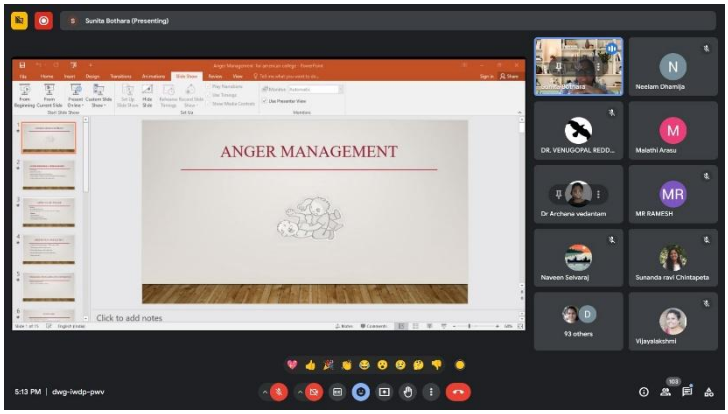
Online webinar on "Social Conformity”

We attended an online webinar on “Social Conformity” led by Mr. Naveen Sharma. He explained conformity as yielding to group pressure, which can occur through bullying, persuasion, or criticism. Classic studies by Jenness (1932) and Solomon Asch (1951) demonstrated how individuals change their views to align with group opinions. Kelman (1958) identified three types of conformity: compliance (seeking approval), internalization (genuine acceptance of group norms), and identification (adopting behaviours to maintain group membership). Deutsch and Gerrard (1955) outlined two main reasons for conformity: normative (desire to fit in) and informational (seeking guidance in uncertain situations).Despite semester exams and college commitments, 23 students from both academies participated in the session.

Online Webinar on “Phubbing”

In an online webinar, family therapist and EFT trainer Sharmilaa Katrela discussed “Phubbing”—the act of ignoring others in favour of using a phone. Phubbing disrupts connections, harms relationships, and threatens basic human needs like belongingness and self-esteem. Studies link it to lower marital satisfaction and higher depression. Common signs include using a phone during meals or social settings. Suggested remedies are no-phone zones and limiting phone use. Out of 52 students from Madurai and Ramnad Academies, only 25 could attend due to exams, so the topic will be taught offline as well.

Online Webinar on “Anger Management”



A webinar on “Anger Management” was conducted by Ms. Sunita Bothara, Lay Counsellor. She explained the nature of anger—its physiological, cognitive, and behavioural aspects—while stressing the importance of identifying triggers and managing emotions effectively. Practical strategies like deep breathing, mindfulness, and physical activity were shared for both short- and long-term relief. The 21 participants found the session highly engaging and useful.

Life Skill Workshop on Health and Hygiene

On 21st April 2024, a highly engaging Life Skills Workshop on “Health and Hygiene” was conducted at Ilakku. The session was facilitated by our dedicated Mentor Teachers, Ms. Susmitha and Ms. Yazhini, who brought their experience and passion for teaching into the classroom.

They explored the importance of maintaining good health and hygiene in daily life, covering essential practices such as personal cleanliness, healthy

habits, and preventive care. Their explanations and real-life examples made the session both practical and eye-opening for the students. A total of **22 enthusiastic students** took part in the workshop. They not only listened attentively but also engaged in discussions and interactive activities, making the session lively and impactful. The knowledge gained will undoubtedly help them adopt healthier routines and carry these practices into their future.

Workshop on "Kidney Awareness"

On Sunday, April 28, 2024, a health workshop was conducted at Ilakku, focusing on "Kidney Awareness.". The workshop was facilitated by Mr. Alagumalai, a representative of TANKER FOUNDATION, Tamilnadu Kidney Research Institute. Throughout the session, Mr. Alagumalai provided an in-depth overview of various topics related to the kidneys. He discussed the origin and activities of awareness. TANKER Foundation is committed to creating awareness about kidney-related issues and providing support to patients undergoing treatment. During the session, Mr. Alagumalai explained the location and function of the kidneys, including a cross-section of the organ. He also covered the risk factors and causes of kidney disease, symptoms and types of kidney disease, temporary kidney disease, kidney transplantation, and the importance of a healthy lifestyle. The students were engaged and enthusiastic throughout the workshop and actively participated in the session. They had their doubts clarified regarding kidney-related diseases and expressed their gratitude for the opportunity to learn more about their health and wellness. In total, the workshop was attended by 28 students.

Workshop on "Smart Techniques to Achieve Our Goal"

On the 19th of May, 2024, Mr. Ariaravelan led an engaging workshop titled "Smart Techniques to Achieve Our Goal" at Madurai Academy. During the workshop, he encouraged students to openly discuss their aspirations and objectives. Each student shared their unique goals and was then guided to categorize them into four partitions based on their level of importance and immediacy: important but not immediate, immediate but not important, important and immediate, and not important or immediate. The students eagerly participated in this activity and presented their plans, gaining valuable insights into how to effectively prioritize and execute their goals. Mr. Ariaravelan also delved into the distinction between desire and goal, shedding light on how wishes can evolve

into concrete goals, the significance of setting goals, the various types of goals, and the application of the SMART criteria in goal setting. This comprehensive discussion left a lasting impact on the sixteen students who attended the workshop, equipping them with the knowledge and tools to navigate their path toward achieving their aspirations. The program had low attendance due to the rainy season and semester exams.

Life skill workshop on "Time Management"

On 20th May 2025, A life skills workshop on "Time Management" was conducted at our academy, facilitated by Mr. Ariaravelan. During the workshop session, he covered the following topics: what scheduling time is, who schedules time, when and why we should schedule time, and the seven faces of life (educational/professional, relationship, health, financial, social activities, recreational/pleasure, and self-development). He also covered how to schedule time, the meaning of time-wasters, examples of time-wasters, reasons for time-wasting, and how to avoid time-wasters. Additionally, he taught the participants about time charts, work matrices, identifying urgent and non-urgent tasks, creating a Gantt chart, creating a daily work planner, and maintaining a work journal. Twenty-six students enthusiastically participated in the workshop session. Today's takeaway message is that punctuality is not just about being on time, but more importantly, respecting our commitments.

Life skill workshop on "Self-Awareness"

On 3rd June 2024, I had the opportunity to lead a workshop under Ilakku where we focused on imparting essential life skills to our students. The workshop delved into "Self-awareness," covering many aspects. I discussed the concept of self-awareness, explored 5 effective ways to cultivate awareness, delved into different types of self-awareness, highlighted its numerous benefits, and emphasized its importance. Additionally, I provided insights into tools for self-awareness, conducted a SWOT analysis, shared valuable tips for enhancing self-awareness, and concluded the session with the empowering slogans "I can do it, I will do it, I must do it."

Life Skill Workshop on "Communication"

9th June 2024 was a fulfilling day as I had the opportunity to lead a life skills workshop centered on the theme of "Communication" for our students. Throughout the engaging session, I delved into several key topics, such as the various types of communication, the common barriers that hinder effective communication, techniques to enhance communication skills, the pivotal importance of effective communication, the five fundamental rules of communication, the seven guiding principles of communication, and the essential steps involved in the communication process. As the session drew to a close, I left the students with the thought-provoking quote, "Great leaders communicate, and great communicators lead.". Seeing a group of twenty-five students actively participating and engaging in the workshop was heartening.

Life skill workshop on "Decision Making"

ILAKKU hosted a life skills workshop on Decision-making on 7th July 2024. The workshop was skillfully facilitated by mentor teachers Sona and Sujitha and had an active participation of thirty-three students. The workshop focused on the intricate process of decision-making, which involves selecting a course of action from multiple alternatives to achieve a desired outcome. It emphasized the importance of considering values, preferences, and beliefs while identifying and choosing the best course of action.

During the workshop, the process of decision-making was broken down into the following key components and steps: 1. Identifying the problem 2. Gathering information 3. Identifying alternatives 4. Evaluating alternatives 5. Choosing an alternative 6. Implementing decision 7. Monitoring and reviewing the outcome. The workshop also provided insights into different types of decision-making, including. Rational Decision-Making 2. Intuitive Decision-Making 3. Creative Decision-Making 4. Collaborative Decision-Making.

Life skill workshop on “Decision Making-Part 2”

The life skills workshop titled "Decision Making - Part 2" was conducted under the guidance of our mentor teachers, Ms. Karthikaiselvi and Ms. Rani, and was attended by twenty-two students. The workshop encompassed an in-depth exploration of decision-making, including the concept of decision-making, various types of decision-making, and the key characteristics of the decision-making process. The session was conducted in a highly participatory manner, with students demonstrating enthusiastic engagement throughout the workshop.

Life skill workshop on “Decision Making -Part 3”

A Life Skills Workshop on “Decision Making - Part 3” was conducted at Ilakku on August 4, 2024. The session was facilitated by mentor teachers Ms. Sowmiya and Ms. Ranjitham, with seventeen students in attendance. The workshop covered fundamental aspects of decision-making, focusing on two primary factors: Policy and Desire. Participants learned that policy decisions should be adhered to strictly, while decisions based on desire can be flexible and adjusted as needed. The workshop also explored various characteristics of decision-making, including:1. Caring 2. Sharing 3. Respecting others' emotions 4. Selfishness 5. Dominance 6. Rudeness 7. Charity. The session was highly participatory, incorporating fun games to engage the students. The participants showed great enthusiasm and actively contributed to the discussions and activities. Overall, the workshop provided valuable insights and practical skills to enhance the students' decision-making abilities.

Life Skill Workshop on Health and Hygiene

On 11th August 2024, a comprehensive life skills workshop on "Health and Hygiene" was organized for the students in attendance. A total of thirty-nine enthusiastic students actively participated in the enlightening session. The workshop delved into an in-depth discussion on the fundamental concepts of health and hygiene, exploring various types such as personal hygiene, environmental hygiene, food hygiene, water hygiene, mental health hygiene, disease prevention, and the significance of health and hygiene in our daily lives.

Workshop on "Interpersonal Relationship"

On 15th September 2024, A workshop on "Interpersonal Relationships" was organized at ILAKKU, with the participation of thirty-two students. The workshop covered a range of topics, including defining interpersonal relationships, types of interpersonal relationships, their importance, key components of healthy interpersonal relationships, effective communication in relationships, stages of relationships, emotional intelligence in interpersonal relationships, challenges, conflict resolution techniques, and methods for maintaining healthy relationships. The students eagerly engaged in the workshop activities, showing great enthusiasm and active participation throughout.

Life skill workshop on "Creative thinking"

On 6th October 2024, A Life Skills Workshop on Creative Thinking was conducted at ILAKKU for students, with thirty participants attending the session today. The workshop covered the following key topics: 1. Introduction to Creative Thinking, 2. Types of Creative Thinking 3. Creative Thinking Techniques 4. Creative Problem-Solving Activity 5. Creativity Games 6. Reflection and Key Takeaways. The session was designed to enhance students' ability to think creatively and apply innovative approaches to problem-solving, while also encouraging self-reflection and interactive learning through hands-on activities and games.

Life skill workshop on “Problem Solving”

On December 29, 2024, we conducted a Life Skills workshop on "Problem Solving" at Ilakku with 31 enthusiastic students. The session highlighted the importance of problem-solving, key steps and techniques**,** and introduced models like PDCA, 5 Whys, and SWOT analysis. Real-world case studies, common pitfalls, and practical tips were also discussed. Students actively participated in discussions and exercises, gaining valuable insights to strengthen their problem-solving abilities.

Life Skill Workshop on Critical Thinking

On 3rd November 2024, ILAKKU hosted an enriching life skills workshop focusing on "Critical Thinking." The session was designed to provide participants with a comprehensive understanding of critical thinking, its importance, and practical applications. Despite challenges posed by semester exams and seasonal illnesses, twenty-seven dedicated individuals attended the workshop, demonstrating their commitment to personal and intellectual growth.

Key Highlights of the Workshop

1. Understanding Critical Thinking 2. Characteristics of Critical Thinkers 3. Benefits of Critical Thinking 4. Essential Critical Thinking Skills 5. Main Forms of Critical Thinking 6. Barriers to Critical Thinking 7. Overcoming Barriers

Conclusion

The workshop was a valuable experience for all attendees, equipping them with the tools and knowledge necessary to enhance their critical thinking abilities. The commitment shown by the participants, even in the face of external challenges, underscores the importance of such educational initiatives. As ILAKKU continues to offer workshops like these, it remains dedicated to fostering the intellectual and personal development of its community.

Special Programs

78th Independence Day Celebration-Dental Camp

On the 78th Independence Day occasion, we organized a Medical Camp for students in collaboration with Surya Medi Groups, Madurai. The camp featured distinguished professionals, Dr. Navid Khan, a Whole Spine Chiropractic Practitioner specializing in Advanced Pelvic Floor Dysfunction and Postural Correction, and Dr. R. Safeel Navid, a BDS, Clinical Psychologist, with a PG Diploma in HR and Guidance and Counseling. Due to the ongoing Independence Day celebrations at their respective educational institutions, attendance was limited to 37 students. Those who participated received valuable insights into dental care and physiotherapy from the attending doctors. The doctors also provided personalized counselling sessions. Student representatives carefully recorded the individual health concerns of the students, and we plan to arrange follow-up treatments for those who require further medical attention. The camp successfully raised awareness among students about the importance of dental and physiotherapeutic care, marking a meaningful contribution to their overall well-being.

Free Medical Camp

A free medical camp was successfully conducted at Ilakku on Sunday, 29th September 2024**,** in collaboration with Madurai Kidney Center**.** The initiative was aimed at extending essential healthcare services to our students, their families, and the surrounding community.

The camp created a warm and welcoming atmosphere, where individuals were encouraged to come forward for preventive care and medical consultation. A team of dedicated healthcare professionals carried out **basic** health screenings, which included blood pressure monitoring, blood sugar testing, febrile assessments, and dietary counselling. In addition to medical examinations, the doctors and staff also offered valuable advice on lifestyle changes and preventive practices to help participants maintain good health.The response from the community was very encouraging. Around 75 individuals—including students, parents, and neighbours—benefited from the services. Many expressed their gratitude, noting that such medical support is often difficult to access in their daily lives.This camp not only addressed immediate health concerns but also raised awareness about the importance of regular check-ups and early detection of health issues. The event stood as a testament to the importance of

community health initiatives, fostering a sense of care, connection, and collective well-being among all who attended.

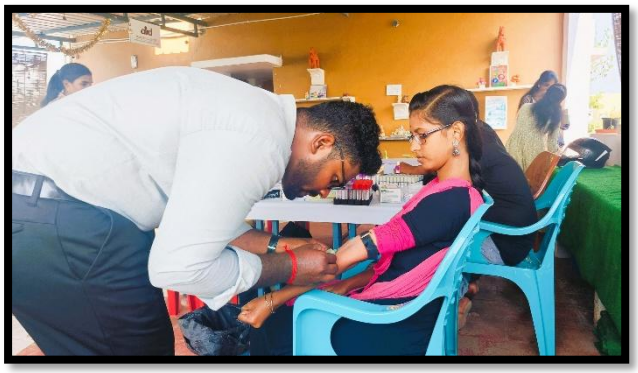
Program Advertisement in Neighbourhood

We are gradually encouraging our students to build meaningful connections with their communities through service-oriented activities. As part of this initiative, we are organizing a health check-up session on Sunday. In preparation for the event, we assigned our students the task of promoting it within the surrounding neighbourhoods.

With great enthusiasm and without any hesitation, the students stepped out into the community. They confidently approached residents, interacted with them politely, and shared details about the upcoming health check-up session. In addition, they took the opportunity to introduce the community members to Ilakku and the various activities and programs we offer.

This outreach experience not only helped raise awareness about the event but also allowed the students to step out of their comfort zones, build communication skills, and understand the value of community engagement. It was heartening to see their energy, responsibility, and growing sense of social involvement.

Health Check-up Camp at Ilakku



A Step Towards Student Well-being

On Sunday, we organized a health check-up camp exclusively for our students, in collaboration with Dr. LalPath Labs Pvt. Ltd. This initiative was part of ILAKKU's ongoing efforts to ensure the overall well-being of our students, alongside their academic growth.

A dedicated team of lab technicians from Dr. LalPath Labs Pvt. Ltd. conducted the health screenings. The tests included Haemoglobin levels, Calcium levels, and Cholesterol levels—three important indicators of general health, especially for young women.

Due to ongoing semester examinations, student participation was slightly limited. However, 22 students were able to attend and benefit from the tests. In addition to our students, a few residents from the neighbouring community of ILAKKU also availed themselves of the opportunity and underwent the health check-up.

The camp was a meaningful step in promoting health awareness among students and the community. It also gave students an insight into the importance of preventive healthcare and regular health monitoring.

As part of our commitment to student well-being, we have decided to maintain individual health charts for all our students. These charts will help us track key health indicators and monitor their physical well-being over time. By conducting periodic health check-ups and

updating the charts regularly, we aim to ensure that any health concerns are identified early and addressed promptly. This initiative reflects our holistic approach to student development—nurturing not only their minds but also their bodies and overall wellness.

Scholarship Interview/ Career Counseling

Our academy has started the scholarship selection process, and we are committed to providing deserving students with financial aid to support their higher education. To ensure that we select the most deserving candidates, we invited students from Kasturiba School for the selection process. The selection panel comprised Ms. Vijayalakshmi, Mr. Ariaravelan, and Dr. Suresh Kumar Murugesan, who are experienced educators and have an excellent track record of identifying deserving students.

We carefully evaluated each candidate based on various criteria, such as being a first-generation college student, first graduate, first attempt, single parent (top priority), monthly income level, house-ownership status, and property details. Besides, we also looked at the students' study aspirations, work aspirations, and family background to better understand their personal and financial situations.
This year, we have selected students school-wise for scholarships to ensure that we provide financial aid to students from all backgrounds. We firmly believe that education is a fundamental right, and we want to ensure that all students have equal access to quality education.

Fruit Vendor-Our Well-wisher

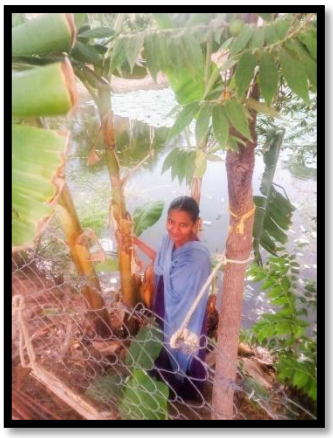
A fruit stall woman entrepreneur, who has been a friend of mine for several years, visited me yesterday, accompanied by a girl who needs support for her education. After touring our academy, she was impressed by our students' positive atmosphere and enthusiasm. Inspired by what she saw, she expressed a desire to distribute fruit salad to the girls as a gesture of support. I told her that her fruit stall is quite far from our academy, and she would incur additional costs for conveyance. I advised her to reconsider her decision due to these potential expenses. However, she was adamant that supporting the girls was her pleasure and honor. True to her word, today she brought a generous amount of fruits at a nominal rate and personally distributed them to all the girls with great joy and enthusiasm. Her kind gesture was deeply appreciated by everyone at the academy.

Student Interview

I had the opportunity to interview six prospective students for enrollment in our Academy. These students were referred to us by our esteemed alumna, Ms. Radha, and our brother, Mr. Raja, from Sorgam Arakattalai. Each of these students comes from an underprivileged background and faces significant challenges in their daily lives. Notably, one of the students comes from an extremely disadvantaged family, where her father struggles with alcoholism, and her mother works as a construction labourer to make ends meet.

Tamil New Year

14th April 2024 marks the beginning of the Tamil New Year, a day of immense significance for people of Tamil origin. It is a day of new beginnings, a day to leave the past behind and embrace the future with optimism and hope. On this auspicious day, we have encouraged our students to reflect on their aspirations and set their resolutions for the forthcoming year. It has been a heartening experience to witness the diverse and ambitious goals that they have set for themselves. The reasons behind their resolutions have also been illuminating, providing an insight into their hopes, dreams, and values. Overall, it has been an enriching experience that has left us all feeling inspired and motivated to pursue our own goals with renewed vigour.



Student story

In the year 2023, Annalakshmi, together with her siblings, planted a plantain tree. Her brother brought a small stem of the tree after his bath in the pond and they carefully planted it, ensuring that it was watered properly. As the days went by, they were delighted to see the budding leaves of the plant and they carefully monitored its growth, ensuring that each part of the plant received the necessary attention. They eagerly awaited the yield and when the bananas were finally ready to be harvested, the whole family celebrated the occasion with joy. Annalakshmi learned the

cultivation techniques of the plantain tree through YouTube and used that knowledge to cultivate more trees. The juice from the plantain tree is known for its effectiveness in curing urinary stones, making it a valuable addition to their home.

In addition to the plantain tree, Annalakshmi also planted an Oma Valli herbal plant in a small bowl. The plant grew very well and her mother used it to prepare healthy herbal drinks for the family. The family was grateful for the bountiful harvest and enjoyed the delicious fruits and herbs that were grown with love and care. Annalakshmi's unwavering determination to become an Aeronautical Engineer is truly inspiring as she diligently works towards her **B.Sc.** in Physics at Yadhava College.

Student Guidance

Ms. Asina is a dedicated student who is currently pursuing her Bachelor of Education (B.Ed.) degree. She is enthusiastic about an upcoming debate in her college on the topic of "Whose role is more important for the development of schools: the Teacher or the Headmaster?" To prepare for the debate, she sought the guidance of Mr. Ariaravelan, who is a highly experienced development professional. During their conversation, Ms. Asina gained some valuable insights and ideas that will help her conduct the debate effectively. With her passion for education and newly acquired knowledge, Ms. Asina is sure to make a profound impact during the debate.

Fun time

After celebrating Menstrual Hygiene Day, we organized a fun outing for our students at Rajaji Park. With the pressure of semester exams weighing heavily on them, their minds were exhausted and in need of a break. To help them relax and rejuvenate, we planned this recreational time in a natural, joyful setting. The visit to the park provided the students with a much-needed opportunity to unwind, enjoy themselves, and strengthen their bond with one another outside the classroom.

Centenary celebration of V. Thillainayagam

The Centenary celebration of V. Thillainayagam, the first Director of the Tamil Nadu Public Libraries Department, was held on June 13, 2025, at the Madurai World Tamil Sangam. Eminent speakers highlighted his contributions to the Library Tamil and public library development. The event saw participation from scholars, librarians, and students. It was a proud moment for ILAKKU students to be part of this memorable occasion.

ILAKKU Sponsors School Bags

Ilakku Sponsors School Bags for Children of a Specially Challenged Parent in Jaihindpuram. Ilakku recently sponsored school bags for the children of a specially challenged parent in Jaihindpuram. This thoughtful gesture brought smiles to the children's faces and eased the family's financial burden. Despite physical challenges, the parent is determined to give their children a good education, and Ilakku’s support reinforces that commitment. The initiative reflects Ilakku’s ongoing mission to uplift underprivileged families and promote inclusive education.

ILAKKU-Growing Library

We happily concluded our year-end acquisition of books at the charming Sarvodaya Ilakkiya Pannai in Madurai, carefully selecting a diverse collection to enrich our library at the Madurai Academy.

Goal Setting Program

The goal-setting program is a distinctive initiative within our activities. Today, students diligently updated their folders, reflecting on their objectives and organizing their strategies. They meticulously tracked their progress, taking meaningful steps toward realizing their aspirations.

Student Interview

Two ambitious young women from the Wakf board were pursuing their undergraduate degrees in Mathematics. They demonstrated a strong drive to succeed, despite facing significant challenges and a lack of support along their educational journey.

Conclusion

This year has been a journey of growth, learning, and resilience. Through the collective efforts of our staff, students, alumni, partners, and supporters, we have been able to create meaningful impact in the lives of young people and their communities. Each program, training, and initiative has strengthened our vision of empowering underprivileged students with education, skills, and opportunities to shape a brighter future.

While we celebrate the achievements of the past year, we also recognize the challenges ahead. With renewed commitment and the continued support of our stakeholders, we look forward to building on our progress, expanding our reach, and deepening our impact in the coming year. Together, we remain steadfast in our mission to nurture confident, capable, and compassionate individuals who will lead positive change in society.